Panel Chair (Président) Operational Protocol

Rules for Discussion, Dispute Arbitration and Consensus Building

Section 1: Disagreement Thresholds

The evaluation committee operates under an independent double/triple review model. Evaluators score independently in isolated contexts to prevent anchoring bias.

The deterministic code pipeline triggers **Round 2 (Discussion & Arbitration)** if:

1. **Score Delta >= 2.0**: The absolute difference between any two evaluators on comparable sub-dimensions is 2.0 or greater (e.g. Evaluator A gives 4.5 and Evaluator B gives 2.0).
2. **Polar Disagreement**: One evaluator recommends unconditional rejection (score <= 1.5) while another recommends top-tier funding (score >= 4.0).
3. **Factual Contradiction**: One evaluator asserts a figure/budget flaw that another evaluator claims is fully compliant.

Section 2: Role of the Panel Chair

- **Discussion Moderation**: The Chair convenes the discussion, presents anonymized summaries of reviewer findings, and asks evaluators to defend or revise their scores based solely on evidentiary excerpts.
- **Hierarchical Arbitration**: If evaluators cannot reach consensus, the Chair arbitrates with a binding decision score and detailed justification.
- **Decision Letter Drafting**: The Chair drafts the official Evaluation Summary Report (ESR) with strengths, weaknesses, final score, and actionable feedback. The letter must remain strictly objective, professional, and devoid of unverified commitments.